

Nova Launcher

Probably the most popular launcher on this list, Nova has been around since 2011. Its initial purpose was to restore certain features that Google had removed from android updates, such as long-press icons for options. It has grown tremendously since then, with functionality for gestures, custom widgets, multiple organised app drawers, third-party app integrations, and so much more.

Simply set Nova as your default launcher to get started. The basic customising is super simple; wallpapers and icons. Once the fundamentals are sorted, we can start with widgets. Long-press on the home screen to get the nova settings overlay.

From there, swipe up to see the list of available widgets. You should have at least one for almost every popular app you have installed, and more. There is even a convenient search bar on top to search by app or other keywords. Each widget can be sized to exactly your specifications.

For anyone who's an organisation freak, you can not only set up clean home pages with your apps but also have dedicated app drawer sections for types of apps. Simply press the settings icon after long-pressing anywhere on the home screen, and select the second option "App drawer".

From here, scroll down to the Apps section, and select "Drawer Groups". Here you can add new tabs, folders, and customise the apps to be shown per tab, the colour associated with the tab, its position, and so on.

Now to access the newly created tab, simply open the app drawer, and swipe left and right to navigate between various tab groups. You can also long-press an app, and choose which app drawer it should go to under the edit feature, denoted by the pencil icon.

There are a lot of customisations for a variety of things, such as icon feel, animations, colour themes, night mode, home screen grid dimensions, dock settings, etc. They can be very easily explored from the first 4-5 options in the settings menu.

But by far the coolest feature that Nova has, is its gesture navigation. This is a premium feature, so you will have to pay a small fee for its Pro version, but it is absolutely worth it. Go to the settings menu, and select "Gestures and Navigations".

You can now set custom actions for a wide variety of gestures, such as swipe up, swipe down, double tap, double swipe up, etc. This normally only works on the home screen, but there is an option to change this as well on the top of the same menu.